

JESSOP Established 1820

Howrah Bridge, Parliament House, India's first electoral multiple unit coach factory. But Jessop is not resting on its laurels.

REBUILDING HISTORY

It is perhaps never easy to take over a company which is so much in the red that even the Government needs help to run it. It is all the more difficult when the company in question has helped build the iconic Howrah Bridge, been part of the team that constructed Parliament House and served as the factory from where India's first electrical multiple unit coach rolled out. So when the Ruia Group decided to enter a joint venture with the Government of India to make Jessop run again, they knew it was not just another company they were taking over. Headquartered in Kolkata from its inception in 1993, the Ruia Group, under the leadership of Pawan Kumar Ruia, 50, is on its way to help Jessop regain its lost glory.

The importance of Jessop is rooted in its history. In 1820, Henry and George, sons of William Jessop of Butterfly Company of Derbyshire, England, bought Breen & Company of Calcutta. Jessop was born in 1820 as part of the Derbyshire company. In 1973, Jessop became a Government of India undertaking and in 1986, it became a subsidiary of the Bharat Bhari Udyog Nigam Limited. In 2003, as part of the strategic disinvestment of the NDA government, Jessop was handed over to the Ruia Group.

Now Ruia basks in the glory of his company's history. "We are privileged to own it. It is a jewel in the Ruia Group," he says, adding, "When we took over Jessop we knew that since infrastructure was now a priority in India there will be no dearth of orders.

We also knew our capability and knew we could make this company a viable profit-making unit again."

Between 1815 and 1840, Jessop built the first iron bridge in India, popularly known as Lohe ka Pul, over the Gomti river in Lucknow. The very symbol of Kolkata, India's first semi-balanced cantilever bridge, the Howrah Bridge, was constructed by it from 1937-43. Jessop is also one of the major suppliers of railway coaches to the Indian Railways and today it is an ISO 9001 and ISO 14001 accredited company with a workforce



JESSOP IS ONE OF THE MAJOR SUPPLIERS OF RAILWAY COACHES IN THE COUNTRY



P.K. RUIA 50, Chairman

"We brought in accountability and a sense of proprietorship. Today a worker in Jessop is again proud to be associated with this company."